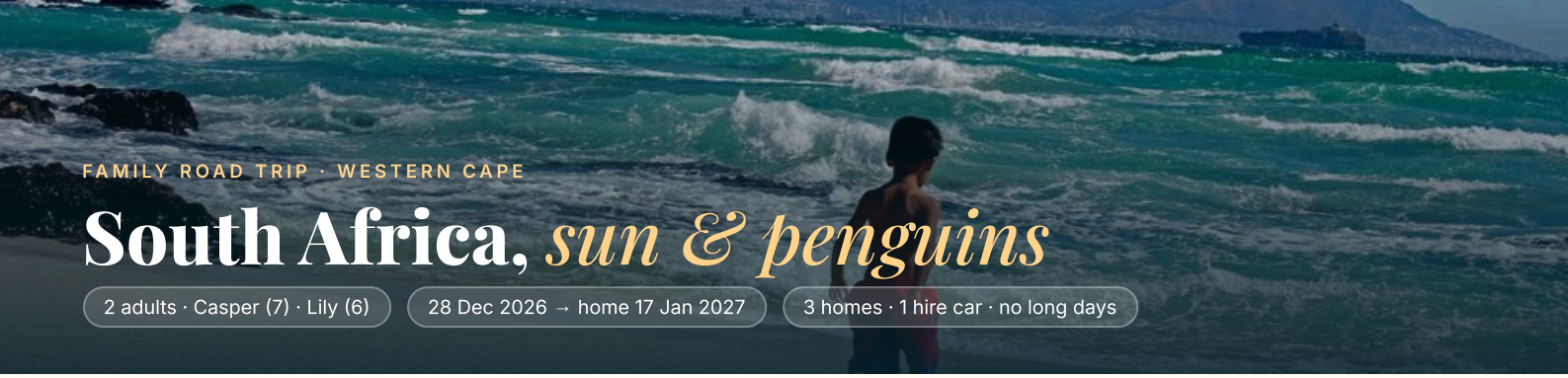


FAMILY ROAD TRIP · WESTERN CAPE

South Africa, *sun & penguins*

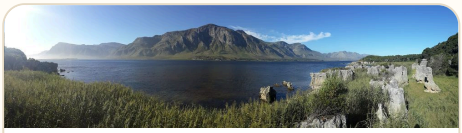
2 adults · Casper (7) · Lily (6) | 28 Dec 2026 → home 17 Jan 2027 | 3 homes · 1 hire car · no long days



Kommetjie · 5 nights
29 Dec – 3 Jan · family home near Long Beach, 3 bed · beaches, penguins, Cape Point



Greyton · 7 nights
3 – 10 Jan · thatch house, fenced garden · oak-lined village, market, river



Hemel-en-Aarde · 6 nights
10 – 16 Jan · Villetta, valley views · Hermanus, Stanford, Klein River

Day by day

Drive times without traffic · ★ = kids' favourite

Mon 28 Dec	**Fly overnight.** British Airways nonstop from Heathrow at 22:20.
CAPE PENINSULA · KOMMETJIE	
Tue 29 Dec	**Land 12:10 (BA nonstop), collect the car.** Supermarket shop on the way, then about 55 min to Kommetjie. Settle in, sunset on Long Beach, early night.
Wed 30 Dec	**Boulders penguins** ★ Go at 08:00 (about 20 min), then Seaforth beach and fish and chips in Simon's Town.
Thu 31 Dec	**Kirstenbosch + New Year's Eve.** The Boomslang treetop walkway (about 35 min). The NYE concert there if tickets come up, otherwise a fire-pit evening at home.
Fri 1 Jan	**Slow day.** Camel and pony rides at Imhoff Farm (5 min), then the beach and rock pools.
Sat 2 Jan	**Cape Point** ★ Lighthouse, ostriches and baboons, then a picnic at Buffels Bay. Do Table Mountain instead if the wind has dropped.
Sun 3 Jan	**Table Mountain cableway** ★ The first car up (the cabin spins), then on to Greyton via Franschhoek for lunch (about 2 h 30 of driving in total).
OVERBERG · GREYTON	
4 – 6 Jan	**Village days.** Walks under the oaks, the river, cafés, and next door Genadendal's mission village. Lazy garden afternoons.
7 – 8 Jan	**Optional: safari.** Aquila (Big Five, ages 4+) is about 2 h 45 away. Do it as a day trip, or stay 1 night and come back.
Sat 9 Jan	**Greyton Saturday market.** A riverside picnic and the last log-fire evening.
WALKER BAY · HEMEL-EN-AARDE	
Sun 10 Jan	**To the valley (about 1 h 30).** Grotto Beach in Hermanus in the afternoon: Blue Flag, lifeguards, gentle sand.
Mon 11 Jan	**Hermanus cliff path.** Dassies, rock pools and ice cream. Big whales have mostly gone by January, so a whale boat isn't worth the money; dolphins are a bonus.
Tue 12 Jan	**Stanford + Klein River canoeing** ★ Paddle the calm river, then lunch in the village. Coot Club's lagoon is next door.
13 – 14 Jan	**Beaches and farms.** Voëlklip and Kammabaai beaches and lunch at a valley farm. Option: the Dyer Island boat from Gansbaai to see seals and penguins.
Fri 15 Jan	**Stony Point penguins.** Drive Clarence Drive to Betty's Bay (about 50 min) for the quieter penguin colony.
Sat 16 Jan	**Fly home.** Check out at 10:00, a long lunch in Hermanus, then about 1 h 30 to the airport for the BA evening nonstop.
Sun 17 Jan	**Home.**

Photos: Table Mountain, South African Tourism (CC BY 2.0); penguins, Satdeep Gill (CC BY-SA 4.0); Greyton, Robvanvee (CC BY-SA 3.0); lagoon, Lourens van Dyk (CC BY-SA 3.0), all via Wikimedia Commons. Drive times are from OSRM routing without traffic, so add 20–30% in the holidays.

What it costs

GBP for the family of four · rand at **R21.92 = £1**
(mid-market rate, open.er-api.com, 16 Oct 2026)

Core costs

ITEM	BASIS	£
Flights, return × 4	British Airways nonstop, LHR 22:20 → CPT 12:10 (11 h 50), home on the BA evening nonstop on 16 Jan. £1,398 per person, return, economy. Child fares assumed equal to adult. Google Flights, 16 Oct.	5,592
Kommetjie home, 29 Dec – 3 Jan	Family home near Long Beach: 3 bedrooms, rated 5.0. Airbnb total, 16 Oct. Alternatives: Aframe Nerina £1,136 · Kalk Bay SeaViews (pool) £981	1,339
Greyton Retreat, 3 – 10 Jan	Airbnb total, 16 Oct. Free cancellation before 4 Dec.	2,426
Villetta, Hemel-en-Aarde, 10 – 16 Jan	Airbnb total, 16 Oct. Free cancellation before 27 Dec.	1,267
Car hire, 7-seater, automatic	Toyota Rumion or similar, CPT 29 Dec – 16 Jan, from £439 (Kayak, 16 Oct), plus 2 child seats at about R605 each (£55). A full-size SUV is from £1,285.	494
Fuel + tolls EST	About 1,400 km at about 7.5 L/100 km, at R29.38/L (95 octane, coastal, Oct 2026, from the FIA), plus Chapman's Peak tolls.	155
Food & drink EST	19 days at about £110 a day: self-catering plus a café or restaurant meal most days.	2,090
Daily extras EST	Parking, ice creams, garden entry and small purchases: about £20 a day.	380
Core total · about £3,436 per person		**£13,743**

Optional extras

★ = in "favourite extras" · 2 adults + 2 children aged 6–7

EXTRA	PRICE USED	RAND	£
★ Table Mountain cableway, return	R475 per adult, R230 per child (online, 2026/27) · tablemountain.net	1,410	64
★ Boulders penguins	R282 / R138, international rate from 1 Nov 2026 · SANParks	840	38
★ Cape Point (Cape of Good Hope)	R592 / R288 · same SANParks source. Funicular extra.	1,760	80
★ Two Oceans Aquarium	R280 per adult, R130 per child aged 4–13 · aquarium.co.za	820	37
★ Kirstenbosch summer concert	R360 per adult, R225 per child aged 6–21 (2025/26 prices; 2026/27 not yet out). NYE concert was R540 each · SANBI	1,170	53
★ Klein River canoeing, Stanford	River Rat: R100 per person, minimum R400 · capeinfo. Kayaks from Lady Stanford are R350–R500 each.	400	18
★ Aquila safari, full day (self-drive)	R2,316 per adult, children aged 4–11 half price (offer price; the December rate isn't confirmed). About 2 h 30 from Cape Town · aquilasafari.com	6,948	317
Aquila, 1 night, full board	Peak 20 Dec – 15 Jan, from R4,775 per person sharing, children half price · rates. 2 nights is about £1,307.	14,325	654
Gondwana (Lehele), 2 nights	R10,000 per person per night, children aged 6–11 half price, plus a conservation fee of R550 / R275 per night. Kids go on drives from age 3. About 4 h 30 from Cape Town · gondwanagr.co.za	63,300	2,888
Dyer Island marine boat, Gansbaai	Seals, penguins and sharks (Dec–Jun). R2,340 per adult, R1,725 per child aged 5–11, + R150 each · sharkbookings	8,730	398
Hermanus whale boat	R1,580 / R790, but the season runs Jun–Nov, so **not realistic in January** · Southern Right Charters	4,740	216
Favourite extras (★)			**£607**

CORE TRIP

£13,743

Flights, 3 homes, car, fuel, food and daily spend

CORE + FAVOURITE EXTRAS

£14,350

Adds the 7 ★ extras, including a day at Aquila. With 1 night at Aquila instead of the day trip: about £14,687.

Safari and ages. Aquila takes ages 4+ on drives and has a Junior Ranger programme. At Gondwana's Lehele lodge, children aged 3+ go on drives. At Sanbona, children stay only at the Gondwana Family Lodge and must be 4+ for drives (not priced; about 3 h 30 away). Inverdoorn isn't suitable: under-12s can't join its scheduled drives.

Not included. Travel insurance, getting to and from Heathrow, the car's excess cover, and drinks on safari. Virgin Atlantic also flies nonstop; its price wasn't checked.

Prices were checked on 16 Oct 2026 and can change. Flights are Google Flights fares and homes are Airbnb totals. Rand prices are converted at R21.92 = £1. EST marks an estimate, not a quoted price.